QP CODE: 24900168

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024
Discipline Specific Core Course - MG1DSCLIH100 - ANGLO-SAXON AESTHETICS TO RENAISSANCE RHETORIC: MAKERS OF ENGLISH LITERATURE
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain][CO No(s)]

Part A

*Multiple Choice Questions. Answer **all** questions. Each question carries **1** mark*

1 Which language continued to be the language of the church after the Norman Conquest? [U] [1, 5]
c) Latin

2 Domesday Book Commissioned in ……. [K] [2, 4, 5]
b) 1086

3 What can be considered as the Bible of English Constitution? [E] [2, 3]
b) Magna Carta

4 Which Spenserian poem follows the tradition of Latin pastoral poetry? [A] [2, 3, 4]
c) The Shepherd's Calendar

5 In which language did Bede write the Ecclesiastical History? [U] [1, 5]
c) Latin

6What is the purpose of the "Æcerbot," or "Field Remedy" charm in Old English tradition? [K] [1, 5]
b) To ensure fertility of crops

7 What significant event in 1066 AD opened a new chapter in the history of England? [U] [1, 5]
b) The Norman Conquest

8 Name some of the Celtic inhabitants who settled in Britain. [An] [5]
d) All of the above

9 Which of the following themes is most commonly found in Old English charms? [K] [1, 5]
b) Healing and protection

10 Name some of the places that are linked together by Roman military roads [U] [1]
d) All of the above

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part B

*Objective Type Questions. Answer any **10** questions. Each question carries **1** mark*

11 What lasting architectural legacy did William I leave in England? [An] [1, 5]
Castles/fortifications

12 Who were known as tenants-in-chief? [U] [2, 4, 5]
A feudal vassal (land lord) and members of the clergy like bishops and abbots who held land directly from the king or a territorial prince

13 Who banned English students attending the University of Paris? [K] [1, 4]
Henry II

14 What is Vasco da Gama renowned for? [U] [1, 5]
First to sail from Europe to India by circumnavigating Africa's Cape of Good Hope – his voyage marked the beginning of European colonial expansion in Asia and Africa.

15. Name the English reformer who stood for the purity of English language as opposed to [K] [1, 5]

the archaic influence of Latinism.

Roger Ascham (as given in the Text) - Sir John Cheke could also be considered for marks.

16. Name the prose text of the Middle English period written by Dan Michel of North-gate in 1340. [K] [2, 3, 5]

The Ayenbite of Inwyt

17. Which reformers sought to reform the Church and society through education, biblical scholarship, and a return to early Christian ideals? [An] [5]

Oxford Reformers

18. What made King Henry VIII break with the Pope? [An] [1, 5]

The Pope's refusal to annul his marriage

19 Define a trading company. [An] [1, 5]

Company that buys and sells products across different markets – imports and exports – engaged in long-distance trading and dealt with larger financial markets

20. Who wrote the first real comedy in English Ralph Roister Doister? [K] [2, 3, 4]

Nicholas Udall

21. Which is Spenser's unfinished work? [K] [2, 4]

The Faerie Queene

22. Who is often referred to as the "Father of English History"? [K] [1, 5]

The Venerable Bede

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part C

*Short Answer Questions (50 Words). Answer any **5** questions. Each question carries 2 marks.*

23. How did William I handle the Danish army during the Saxon revolt? [An] [1, 5]

Paid the Danish army to leave England

24. Write a short note on Book of Common Prayer [K] [1]

Thomas Cranmer compiled – official prayer book of Anglicans - influenced English literature

25. Write a brief note on the Dutch Revolt in the sixteenth century. [U] [1, 5]

Dutch Revolt or the Eighty Years' War - conflict between Netherlands and Spain - 16th and 17th centuries - discontented Protestants vandalised countless Catholic churches (1566) in Flanders and soon spread - William of Orange successfully led the fight for liberation from 1572.

26. Write about the significance of Thomas Kyd in English Literature. [An] [2, 3, 4]

Significant figure in the development of Elizabethan drama - known for *The Spanish Tragedy* - the earliest example of the English revenge play

27. Describe briefly the famous character Dr. Faustus. [U] [2, 3, 4]

Brilliant scholar dissatisfied with limits of human knowledge – strikes pact with devil – moral degradation as he indulges in temporary pleasures – refuses to repent & hence tragic downfall – shows Marlowe's understanding of human nature

28. Name the longest single poem of Chaucer which owes much to the influence of Dante. [A] [2, 3, 5]

The Parlement of Foules or *The Parlement of Fowls*

29. Name the two important English writers whose works were printed in Caxton's printing press. [U] [1, 5]

. Geoffrey Chaucer, John Gower, Thomas Malory, etc.

30. Write a short note on Shakespearean comedies. [U] [2, 3, 4]

Marked by wit, humor, intricate plots - explore themes of love, identity, societal norms - blend mistaken identities, clever wordplay, and happy endings - celebrate human folly and resilience, offering timeless reflections on the complexities of relationships and life.

(5× 2 = 10)

Part D

*Short Essay Questions (150 Words). Answer any **5** questions. Each question carries **5** marks.*

31. How did William I use castles to keep control over England? [An] [1, 5]

Built in prominent locations - extrememly large, to intimidate the local population - along the coasts and vulnerable areas on the borders with Wales and Scotland to protect from invaders - bases for barons and their soldiers to control the local area, collect taxes, and trade - consolidate control of England.

32. Comment on the contributions of John Wycliffe as a translator and religious reformer. [An][1, 3, 5]

"Morning Star of the Reformation" - seminal figure in religious reform and biblical translation - emphasized primacy of Scripture over ecclesiastical tradition - translation of the Bible into Middle English - made the Scriptures accessible to ordinary believers - Laid the foundation for later reformers - critiqued Church corruption asserting Christ, not the Pope, was head of the Church - ideas spread by his followers, the Lollards.

33. Spenserian sonnet [U] [2, 3, 4]

Based on themes of unrequited love and inner conflict - vivid imagery and classical allusions - rhyme scheme: abab bcbc cdcd ee – helped create a more interconnected flow between quatrains.

34. The role of trade in influencing geographical explorations and English colonialism in the sixteenth century. [E] [1, 5]

Maritime ambitions fuelled by desire to find new trade routes to lucrative Eastern markets - England wanted to establish its own foothold in global trade - Prospect of wealth – major motivator - establishment of colonies in the New World - promise of riches and resources

35. Write a short note on the general characteristics of Chaucer's poetry. [A] [2, 3, 5]

Storytelling Mastery - weaves diverse stories through multiple perspectives - Diverse Themes of of love, morality, religion, class, and human nature - **Rich Characterization** - vivid, realistic characters representing various social classes and professions - **Humour and Satire** - wit and irony to critique societal norms, particularly the Church and aristocracy - **Use of Middle English** - made it a literary language accessible to a wider audience - **Varied Literary Forms** like allegory, romance, fabliau, and didactic tales - **Skilful Versification** - uses iambic pentameter and rhyme schemes innovatively, notably the rhyming couplet - **Influence of Classical and Continental Traditions** - reflects influences from Dante, Boccaccio, and Ovid, blending classical and medieval elements - **Realism and Humanism** - focuses on human experiences and emotions.

36. Briefly describe about the earliest inhabitants of England? [U] [1]

Paleolithic Age - Hunter-gatherers used simple stone/bone tools and lived in caves or temporary shelters - Climate fluctuations led to periods of habitation and abandonment - also called Old Stone Age. **Neolithic Age** - transition to farming with domestication of plants and animals & engaged in trade - construction of permanent homes and megalithic structures like Stonehenge - also called New Stone Age- **Bronze Age** - introduction of metal tools and weapons - dead buried in small round burial mounds - development of engineering skills.

37. How did Christianity encourage the growth of art and literature in England? [U] [2]

Introduction of religious themes - monasteries as cultural centres - church patronage of the arts - growth of education and literacy - moral and allegorical literature - promotion of music.

38. Shakespearean sonnets. [U] [2, 3, 4, 5]

154 sonnets – 3 quatrains and rhyming couplet – Themes of love, beauty, time, mortality especially time's destructive power - 2 sequences - address a fair youth: admiration & affection tinged with frustration & longing - address a dark lady: obsession, guilt, moral ambiguity - Portray complex tumultuous emotional landscape

(5× 5 = 25)

Part E

*Essay Questions (300 Words). Answer any **1** question. The question carries **15** marks.*

39. How did the Norman Conquest change the social and political structure of England? [An] [1, 5]

Implementation of Feudal System – introduced by William the Conqueror - centralizing power and reorganizing land ownership - land was granted to Norman lords (barons) in exchange for military service - English peasantry became serfs, bound to the land and under the control of local lords.

Redistribution of Land - nearly all Anglo-Saxon nobles lost their lands, which were redistributed to Norman elites - The Domesday Book (1086) was created to document land ownership and resources, strengthening centralized control.

Centralization of Power - the monarchy gained significant authority, with William controlling vast swathes of land directly - castles were built across England to assert Norman dominance and suppress rebellion.

Changes in Governance - Anglo-Saxon administrative systems, like the shire and hundred courts, were retained but overseen by Norman officials - Norman-French became the language of the ruling class, law, and administration.

Transformation of the Aristocracy - Anglo-Saxon nobility was largely replaced by Norman lords, creating a new elite class loyal to William.

Cultural and Legal Shifts - Norman customs and laws, such as primogeniture, were introduced. - ecclesiastical reforms aligned the English Church more closely with Rome, replacing Anglo-Saxon clergy with Normans.

Military Reorganization - Norman knights and cavalry replaced the Anglo-Saxon fyrd (militia). - castles fortified Norman control and served as military strongholds.

Impact on Language and Culture - Norman-French heavily influenced the English language, blending with Anglo-Saxon to form Middle English - architecture, such as Romanesque churches and cathedrals, flourished under Norman influence.

Suppression of Rebellion - harsh measures, such as the Harrying of the North (1069–1070), ensured Norman dominance and quashed resistance.

40. Why do we remember King John's rule for the Magna Carta, the Bible of the English Constitution? [E] [2, 3, 5]

Compromise between the barons and the crown that contained several groundbreaking reforms in judicial & local administration - Influences legal & political thought - Foundational rules of law & individual liberty - Parliamentary consent needed for taxation - Set precedent for constitutional limits on royal power

(1 × 15 = 15)

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